

Lab 1: Install Hermes Agent and Run a Safe First Session

Business Innovation with AI Agents · TGS-2020503395 · 35 minutes

Objective

Install Hermes through the official path, complete provider setup, verify the runtime and run a bounded read-only task.

Deliverable

An installation verification record with version, doctor result, provider route, session evidence and cleanup status.

Prerequisites

- A trainer-approved laptop and classroom workspace.
- Use only fictional data supplied in this lab.
- Do not paste API keys, customer data or personal information into evidence.
- A provider account or trainer-provided classroom route; never submit its credential.

Procedure

Step 1. Open the official Hermes repository and verify the publisher is NousResearch and the connection uses HTTPS.

Step 2. Review the installer before execution if required by organisational policy. On macOS, Linux or WSL2, run the official installer.

```
curl -fsSL https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.sh | bash
```

Step 3. Reload the shell so the hermes command is on PATH.

```
source ~/.zshrc # macOS zsh
```

```
# or: source ~/.bashrc
```

Step 4. Start the setup wizard. Select the trainer-approved provider and store credentials only in the Hermes-managed location.

```
hermes setup
```

Step 5. Record version and diagnostics without recording secret values.

```
hermes --version
```

```
hermes doctor
```

```
hermes config check
```

Step 6. Start Hermes in the lab folder and ask it to summarise the fictional business brief without changing files.

```
hermes
```

Step 7. Confirm the response cites the supplied brief, states uncertainty and makes no external action.

Step 8. Complete installation-verification.md and run the bundle verifier.

```
python3 verify.py
```

Step 9. Exit the session. If a classroom credential was temporary, revoke it with the trainer.

Acceptance test

Hermes starts, diagnostics identify a configured provider, the first response uses only fictional evidence, and installation-verification.md is complete.

Evidence checklist

- ☐ Commands/configuration with secrets redacted
- ☐ Screenshot or file evidence
- ☐ Acceptance test result
- ☐ Failure and resolution
- ☐ Reflection and improvement

Safety and cleanup

- Use fictional data only.
- Never submit .env, tokens, keys or personal information.
- Stop classroom gateways and remove recurring jobs after evidence capture.